COVER LETTER FOR SUBMISSION TO SCOPUS Q1 JOURNAL

Date: March 15, 2026

To:

Prof. Reda Alhajj, Ph.D.

Editor-in-Chief, *Social Network Analysis and Mining* (SNAM)

Springer Nature Switzerland

Subject: Submission of Original Research Manuscript for Peer Review

Dear Professor Alhajj and Members of the Editorial Board,

We are pleased to submit our original research manuscript entitled **"Mapping the 'Phygital Gap' in Public Policy Crisis: A Tri-Layer Computational Communication Study of Indonesia's Free Nutritious Meal (MBG) Program on Platform X"** for consideration for publication as a Full Research Article in *Social Network Analysis and Mining* (SNAM).

Research Context and Alignment with SNAM

In contemporary algorithmic public spheres, public relations and crisis communication increasingly grapple with the decoupling of physical policy execution from digital promotional narratives. While conventional social network research and sentiment analysis are often conducted in isolation—NLP disregarding structural power topologies and network science overlooking nuanced emotional payloads—our study presents an integrated, multidisciplinary **Tri-Layer Computational Communication Science** framework. Given SNAM's premier global standing in publishing pioneering methodologies that fuse complex network analysis, data mining, and social computing to address high-consequence societal issues, we believe our manuscript aligns directly with the core Aims and Scope of your journal.

Summary of Methodological Innovation and Findings

Auditing a verified inference corpus of $N = 5,263 tweets and a dedicated sarcasm validation corpus of N = 3,395$ tweets surrounding Indonesia's multi-billion-dollar Free Nutritious Meal (Makan Bergizi Gratis / MBG) program, our study establishes three interrelated computational layers:

1. **Micro-Affective Layer:** Utilizing a fine-tuned transformer language model (indobenchmark/indobert-base-p2), we classify 9 granular Plutchik emotions, discovering that public affective resistance is overwhelmingly anchored in visceral **Disgust (56.24%, 2,960 tweets)** and **Trust (20.39%)**, while secondary emotions collectively account for less than 2%.

2. **Meso-Semiotic Layer:** Grounded in Clark & Gerrig's *Pretense Theory*, we model binary lexical contradictions and text-emoji semiotic incongruence, successfully validating **315 sarcastic tweets (9.28%)** that weaponized derisive emojis (, ,) alongside superficial praise, thereby safeguarding sentiment scoring from false-positive bias.

3. Macro-Topological Layer: Directed graph modeling ($|V| = 971$ nodes, $|E| = 666$ directed edges) revealed extreme network sparsity (density = 0.0011) and near-zero reciprocity (1.21%), demonstrating a breakdown of deliberative dialogue into echo chambers, confirmed by hyper-fragmentation with a Louvain modularity score of $Q = 0.9837$ across 332 isolated clusters.

Theoretical and Conceptual Breakthroughs

Crucially, our study bridges Philip Kotler's Marketing 6.0 concept of the **Phygital Gap** with Coombs' Situational Crisis Communication Theory (SCCT). Through Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis (ABSA), we empirically substantiate that public outrage concentrated specifically on physical operational breakdowns: Logistics & Distribution (**78.91% Disgust**), Budgeting & Vendor Procurement (**77.01% Disgust**), and Nutritional Integrity (**71.13% Disgust**). Furthermore, structural centrality revealed a profound **Power Asymmetry**: the designated state authority figure (@prabowo) manifested high in-degree (15) but zero out-degree (0)—creating an epistemic power vacuum that compelled citizens to turn to an artificial intelligence bot (@grok, out-degree = 42) as a de facto **Algorithmic Oracle** to adjudicate policy truths.

Formal Declarations

We confirm the following ethical and professional standards:

- **Originality:** This manuscript is an original work that has not been published previously and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere (*no simultaneous submission*).

- **Compliance with Double-Blind Review:** In addition to this Title Page and Cover Letter, we have uploaded an Anonymized Manuscript that fully redacts all author and institutional identifiers.

- **Open Science & Reproducibility:** All datasets, edge lists, evaluation reports, and Python replication codes are publicly available in our open-access GitHub repository: https://github.com/indri007/INDOBERT-9-EMOJI-TESIS-ANALISIS-SNA.

- **Ethical Integrity:** Research was conducted strictly adhering to Platform X Developer Policies and academic data mining ethics; only public aggregate data were analyzed.

- **Approval:** All authors have actively contributed to the conceptualization, execution, and writing of this study, and all have reviewed and approved the manuscript for submission.

Thank you very much for your time, consideration, and management of the peer-review process. We look forward to receiving the reviewers' constructive feedback.

Sincerely yours,

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